

Hi, I'm Léa GIEZEK

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French (native) · English (fluent) · German (bonus)
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Design & Creative Leader, from brand to product, from R&D to every touchpoint. 15 years across brand, retail, agency and product, the last 10+ in a research-driven global healthcare group.

Governance Finalist, Design System Awards 2025

MOVING DESIGN PRACTICE FORWARD

Trusted from the front line to the top. Navigating and aligning a complex global matrix; eight years working with senior executives and leading design investment cases.

One identity, every channel. Translating and evolving brands from physical to digital: spaces, events, campaigns, sites and products.

VP-level scope: Up to €1M, a team of 9. time-to-launch ÷3, 810+ development days saved.

Adopted, not imposed. One experience system across 45+ products and platforms. 100% adoption in Sanofi's 3 strategic Digital Accelerators (Commercial, Manufacturing, R&D).

Influence over headcount. From 0 to 35+ contributors with the same team. 2,000+ practitioners in the ecosystem.

Cultivating practice, not just systems, through Design Leadership and Community Building.

Experience

NOV 2023 - NOW | SANOFI

Elements Experience System Director

Leading Elements, Sanofi's unified experience system: one design language connecting brand and product across 45+ digital products and platforms worldwide, from employee to patient (B2C, B2B, E2E).

Investment case: Authored the annual financial business case for the Elements Experience Platform, validated each year by the Chief Digital Officer (Executive Committee), and the quarterly business-impact reporting; presented platform progress and next steps to the CDO in field sessions within the Digital Accelerators.

Executive alignment: Aligned the CDO's leadership team - Heads of Consumer Experience, Engineering and the 3 Digital Accelerators - on joint priorities, in quarterly reviews and 1:1s as priorities shifted.

Vision & strategy: Set the multi-year strategy and roadmap; extended Elements to native apps, emailing and a content system, connecting brand and product for the first time.

Organisation & people: Owned up to €1M a year, from arbitration to forecast and monitoring. Secured permanent internal positions in place of freelance roles and built a core team of 9, organised by capability with accountable leads.

Influence & community: Partnering with the Experience Design Organisation of 100, including 30+ product designers. A core interdisciplinary community of 300+ across 5 global hubs, from 0 to 35+ contributors in 18 months through inner-source governance, 4.7/5 satisfaction score.

Business impact: 87% component usage per product; time-to-launch cut by 3 on strategic launches such as Beyfortus.

Innovation: Led AI readiness across the design-to-code pipeline: internal MCP, Figma AI Companion, Claude Skills, GitHub pilots.

Design systems ship standards. Experience systems grow culture. That's my leadership bet.

I believe in people to move systems forward. Not the other way around. Never alone, always.

Moving from traditional DesignOps to something more human, one platform of shared practices, built on trust and humility.

Complexity turned simple - that's what a seamless brand experience looks like.

Brand consistency under constraint, without compromising its expression - that's the system's job.

Drivers

Experiences that scale

Brand platforms
Multi-surface foundations
Campaigns & content systems
Systemic patterns

Leading with executives

Executive alignment
Executive storytelling
Investment cases
Data-driven decisions

People & practice

DesignOps
Communities of practice
Leadership by influence
Organisation design
Change management

Levers that matter

Product strategy
Service design
Continuous discovery
Business thinking

Craft, augmented

Figma, Claude, GitHub
AI-augmented workflows
Living documentation
Responsible design

Non-negotiables

Human-first
Inclusion as infrastructure
Trust over control
Team health

APR 2021 - OCT 2023 | SANOFI

Product Design Lead · Elements, founded from zero

Executive partnership: Built and presented the design system case to move Elements from an agency model to a fully in-house team, from design to engineering, approved by the Chief Digital Officer, with the backing of the Head of Design.

Build: Rebuilt the design system foundations, Figma kit, React repositories and documentation from scratch in under a year, with a core Elements team of 2 designers and 4 engineers, fully WCAG AA compliant.

Digital transformation: Drove adoption across Sanofi's first commercial Digital Accelerator, launched by the Chief Digital Officer as the group shifted to an agile, product-based organisation.

Brand & corporate experience: Led the sanofi.com redesign in partnership with the Head of Corporate Communications: Information Architecture simplified by 60%, CMS overhaul for content owners.

People: Responsible for 3 product designers across parallel products, as the design-quality interface with their product owners, including mentorship.

MAR 2018 - APR 2021 | SANOFI

Digital Communications Service Owner · Brand platform

Executive partnership: Advised the Heads of Digital for Vaccines, R&D and Medical on their communication plans. Monthly and quarterly updates to their Executive Committee member, and annual employee campaigns per business unit - 100,000+ employees reached.

Brand & identity: Created and owned the Sanofi IT brand platform, sponsored by the Chief Digital Officer: identity, guidelines, templates and asset system for 2,500+ digital employees.

Innovation & engagement: Led communications, from strategy to visual production, for Sanofi's first Captivate hackathons, sponsored by the Chief Medical Officer and the Global Head of Research and Development: 6,000 participants, 103 ideas, 8,301 votes; one idea shipped as the Theia® app.

OCT 2016 - MAR 2018 | MICROPOLE FOR SANOFI

Digital Consultant · Internal communications

Executive partnership: Co-organised the annual seminar of Sanofi's top 150 digital leaders, with sign-off directly from the Chief Digital Officer. Visual production, scenography, agenda and stakeholder orchestration. Helped digital leaders turn complex strategic topics into simple, compelling stories.

Brand & experience: Led brand identity and experience for Sanofi's booths at European events such as VivaTech, with Corporate Communications.

Method: Industrialised the campaign methodology across the digital organisation - reusable templates, toolkits, performance tracking.

2011 - 2016 | EARLY CAREER

Brand, retail, agency and first steps at Sanofi

Sanofi Digital (2015 – 2016): Creative assets and space branding for the IT department; UX and information architecture for the IT intranet.

Lowepro & JOBY (2014 – 2015): Brand communication for two consumer brands, B2B and B2C - launch campaigns, retail assets, trade-show space branding (Salon de la Photo Paris), social media management, first UX work on the e-commerce site.

Decathlon (2011 – 2014): Ran one of the store's three highest-revenue departments - merchandising, in-store activation, customer events resulting in +17% sales revenue in 2 years.

Caribou Agency (2012): Omnichannel loyalty campaigns for three client accounts, bridging operations between creatives and clients.

The human behind the career

I have a soft spot for **candour**, **bold colours**, **Bauhaus**, **co-op games**, a good **burger in front of a Ghibli** masterpiece, or simply jumping with my **horse**. I have no patience for hypocrisy, injustice or Rainbow Road in Mario Kart, even though **I love karting**.

Education

NN/g UX Certification in Design Management & Strategy
Master's degree (top of class) in Brand Management (Sup de Pub)
Master's degree in Digital Advertising (INSEEC)
Bachelor in Business Management (ESCEM), incl. 6 months at Hochschule Pforzheim (Germany) - **Creative Advertising track**